

Lei Bill Wang

University of Texas at Austin
Department of Economics

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Research Interests

Public economics, algorithmic fairness

Employment

Postdoctoral researcher under Peter Bergman at UT Austin	2026 - 2027 (expected)
Statistical learning RA under Patrick Pun at Nanyang Technological University	2018 - 2020

Education

Ph.D. Economics, Ohio State University	2020 - 2026.
B.S. Mathematics and Economics, Nanyang Technological University	2014 - 2018.

Working Papers

1. Policy Targeting with Binary Classification Trees: an Application to Rural Hospital Closures (with Hongying Li)
2. Identifying Inattention and Active Choice in Incomplete Social Assistance Takeup: The Case of WIC (with Sooa Ahn)

Publications

1. Lei Bill Wang, Zhenbang Jiao, Fangyi Wang (2026) Policy-Oriented Binary Classification: Improving (KD-)CART Final Splits for Subpopulation Targeting *Proceedings of the 29th International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Statistics*, PMLR 300, 721–729, 2026
2. Lei Bill Wang, Zhenbang Jiao, Om Prakash Bedant and Haoran Wang (2026) Balancing Efficiency and Equity in Classroom Assignment under Endogenous Peer Effects *Journal of Applied Economics*, 29:1, **First place at Hayes Forum poster competition 2024.**
3. Chi Seng Pun, Lei Wang and Hoi Ying Wong (2020) Financial Thought Experiment: A GAN-based Approach to Vast Robust Portfolio Selection *Proceedings of the Twenty-Ninth International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence Special Track on AI in FinTech*
4. Chi Seng Pun and Lei Wang (2019) A Cost-Effective Approach to Portfolio Construction with Range-Based Risk Measures *Quantitative Finance*, 21:3, 431-447
5. Minwook Kang and Lei Wang (2019) Pareto Criterion and Long-Term Perspective Criterion under Myopic Discounting *Economics Bulletin*, 39:1, 24-32

Teaching

Math camp teaching assistant	2024 - 2025
Micro qualification exam tutor	2023 - 2025
PhD Econometrics I (ECON8731) recitation leader	2022 - 2024
World History of Economy Development (ECON4130) independent instructor	2021
Multivariate Analysis (MH4501) teaching assistant	2020
Statistical Learning and Data Mining (MH4510) teaching assistant	2019, 2020

Professional Activities

Research assistant for Jason Blevins and Eric Mbakop	2025 July -
Reviewer for NeurIPS	2025
Organizer for OSU Labor and Econometrics student reading group	2021 - 2023
Participant of Chicago OCE Summer School and Conference	2023

Awards and Grants

G.S. Maddala Prize in Econometrics (\$2,500)	2025
First place at the Hayes Forum Poster Competition (\$200)	2024
Tom Kniesner and Debbie Freund Award (\$5,000)	2024
Optimization Conscious Econometrics Summer School travel grant (\$1,600)	2023

Leadership Experiences

Council of Graduate Students Chair of Research and Data Operations Committee	2022 – 2026
Council of Graduate Students Delegate of the Department of Economics	2022 – 2025
Economics Graduate Student Society Treasurer	2021 – 2022

Personal

Born on Nov 11, 1993.

Chinese Citizen with F1 Student Visa. 3-year OPT starting in Aug 2026.

References

Prof Jason Blevins (Advisor)
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 The Ohio State University
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Prof Alex Hollingsworth
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 (614) 292-6701
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Prof Meta Brown
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 The Ohio State University
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